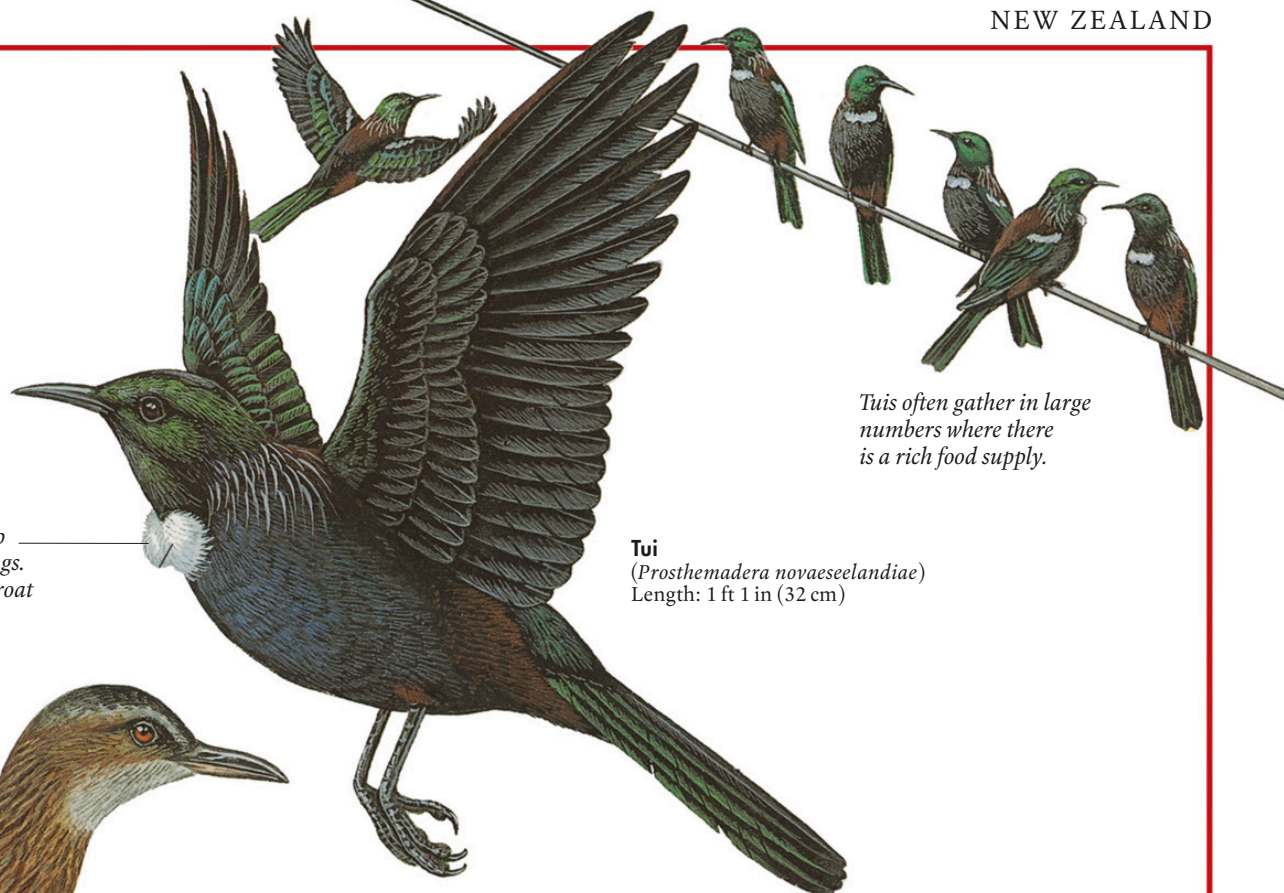


Tui

The tui is nicknamed the parson bird because the white tuft of feathers on its throat looks like the white collar worn by Christian priests or pastors. Tuis are a kind of honeyeater, and use their brush-tipped tongues to lap up nectar from flowers. They are noisy birds that fly at high speed. In the breeding season, males make spectacular dives to impress females. They roll and loop the loop as they hurtle downward.

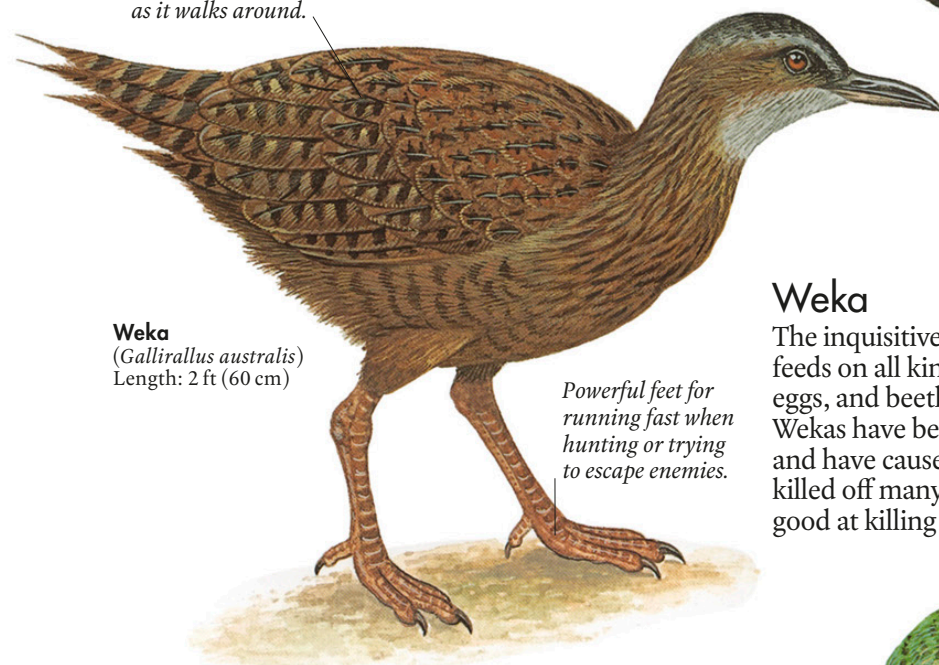


Tuis often gather in large numbers where there is a rich food supply.

White throat tuft bobs up and down as the bird sings. Females have smaller throat tufts than males.

Tui
(*Prothemadera novaeseelandiae*)
Length: 1 ft 1 in (32 cm)

Strong wings help the bird keep its balance as it walks around.



Weka
(*Gallirallus australis*)
Length: 2 ft (60 cm)

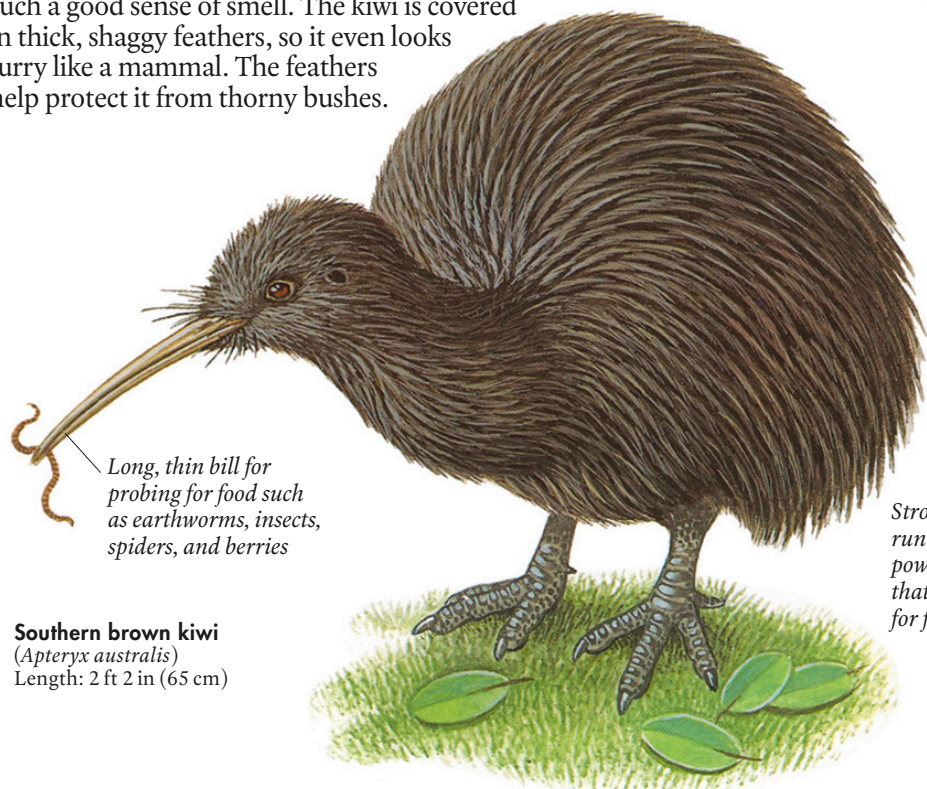
Powerful feet for running fast when hunting or trying to escape enemies.

Weka

The inquisitive weka cannot fly despite its well-developed wings. It feeds on all kinds of food, from grass, seeds, and fruit to mice, birds, eggs, and beetles. It even steals food from trash cans near houses. Wekas have been introduced to some of New Zealand's smaller islands and have caused serious problems. They have damaged the plants and killed off many other birds that live on the ground. They are, however, good at killing the rats that attack New Zealand's rare birds.

Southern brown kiwi

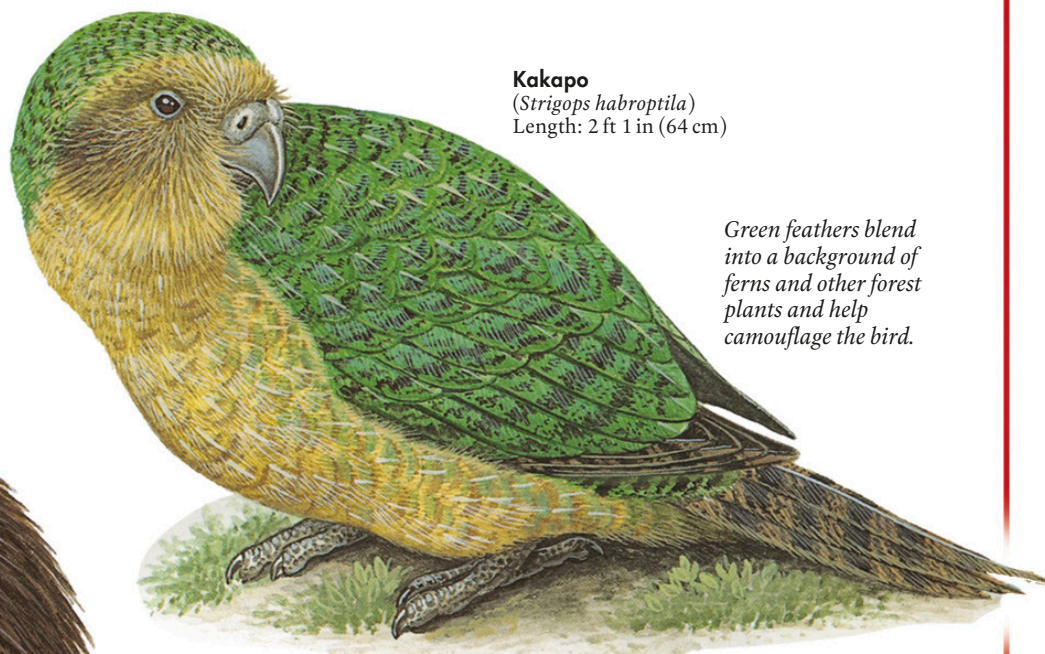
The Southern brown kiwi cannot fly and behaves more like a mammal than a bird. It comes out at night and stalks through bushes and leaves in the forests, sniffing out food with nostrils on the tip of its long bill—it is rare for a bird to have such a good sense of smell. The kiwi is covered in thick, shaggy feathers, so it even looks furry like a mammal. The feathers help protect it from thorny bushes.



Southern brown kiwi
(*Apteryx australis*)
Length: 2 ft 2 in (65 cm)

Long, thin bill for probing for food such as earthworms, insects, spiders, and berries

Strong legs for running and powerful claws that can scratch for food



Kakapo
(*Strigops habroptila*)
Length: 2 ft 1 in (64 cm)

Green feathers blend into a background of ferns and other forest plants and help camouflage the bird.

Kakapo

This is one of the rarest parrots in the world. The kakapo lives on the ground and only comes out at night. It is too heavy to fly, with a thick layer of fat under its skin that makes up about 40 percent of its body weight. In the breeding season, males gather together at special places in the forest and make loud, booming calls that carry for up to ½ mile (1 km). To make the calls louder, they dig a hollow under tree roots, which works like a megaphone. They also expand their bodies with air, like a balloon.